

Face-2-Face with Employer

“These are one of the few businesses where you feel that you are not just working for a larger business, but where you are actually protecting yourself, your family, friends and the world itself. It becomes a fight of good versus evil, and hence gives you a sense of satisfaction that most jobs cannot,”

Request for Anonymity
Development Manager
MNC Security Company

- Experience developing and testing web-based applications
- Experience with static code or binary analysis tools
- Solid understanding of common networking protocols: TCP, IP, UDP, HTTP, SSL
- Prior experience with security products

A career in computer security isn't only about anti-viruses and firewalls anymore, it is now also about network security, data leak protection and security on the mobile phone as well. Network security is about tapping into a network to steal information. Data protection includes stealing data through a USB. Ram Chandra (name changed on request) interestingly points out that during the recession, a lot of people were laid off. A few of these disgruntled employees may have a tendency to do damage to the organisation.

Employers in security:

☐ **Organisations with an in-house security team:** most large organisations have a team dedicated to security from a desktop to the network level. Their responsibility is to keep the company's information intact. This could be the credit card information in a bank or a call centre.

☐ **Security companies:** companies such as Symantec, McAfee create security solutions at the desktop and handset level and even provide security solutions for other large companies

☐ **Private forensic firms:** These firms specialise in tracking down crimes in this space. Their role is to identify how the crime was done on a computer or network. Their role ends once they have cracked this. After this is done, law enforcement moves in to take action.

Possible mid-career changes

Rakesh Goyal, Sysman, believes that a career-change is an option at any point, if the candidate has experience in the business processes of a specific industry. That industry will always welcome any security-oriented person. A security specialist that specialises in a certain domain, such as developing security solutions for a network can always choose to go into a company that develops networking products. Likewise, someone specialising in mobile phone security can always switch to a handset manufacturer. However considering the interesting nature of the job and the competitive salary, this sort of switch is not very common.

Future prospects

As IT and IT assets are growing, so is the number of criminals. Thus, growth

Potential employers

In-house security division

This can be any of the large organisations where information holds high value.
Examples: HDFC, ICICI, Amazon.com

Computer security companies

Companies that specialise in various aspects of security. Specialisation ranges from desktops to handsets to networks.
Examples: McAfee, Symantec, F-Secure

Computer Forensics firms

Firms that specialise in cyber-forensic investigations
Examples: Sysman, Foundation Futuristic Technologies, Lab Systems (I)